see, the board of directors was considerably expanded, there were some dropouts and VOC's position in the company changed.

⚓

Subramania Bharati, who had welcomed the first notice of the company in June, gushed when the prospectus was issued in August 1906. Welcoming the venture wholeheartedly, and exhorting the promoters to march forward courageously, he hoped that the company would be registered soon and the share capital fully subscribed. The possible participation of the Japanese, he was particular to point out, would bolster the hope of Indian capacity-building in navigation.[28]

Registering the Company

The arguments about the prospectus notwithstanding, the task of registering the company under the Indian Companies Act VI of 1882 went ahead in right earnest. There were some teething troubles, not unexpected given the inexperience of the promoters and the scale of the effort. How often did a bunch of traders and a patriotic pleader in a small town set out to register a joint-stock company?

The registration was first scheduled for 24 September; but was delayed. Reports indicated that it was now held over for either the 25th or the 26th.[29] But that too was not to be. It took a few more weeks for the registration to go through.

Eventually, the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company Limited, Tuticorin was registered as No. 13 of 1906–07 on 16 October 1906—the first anniversary of the Partition of Bengal, probably little more than a coincidence. The authorized capital was Rs 10 lakh. At the time of registration, the company had a paid-up capital of Rs 2 lakh. The registered office was at No. 85, Great Cotton Road, Tuticorin.

By the time the company was registered some significant changes had been made. The prospectus issued on 1 November under the hand of VOC